

Philipp Hilbert. *Technical Product Owner for campus management software.*

Positioning, hands-on product owner with nearly ten years translating complex operational workflows into scalable B2B SaaS – ready to own academyFIVE's technical roadmap.

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§ WHY SIMOVATIVE

Campus management is a domain with real operational depth – enrollment, accreditation, scheduling, billing, and document flows all intersecting in one system. The job description asks for someone who can bridge fachliche Vision and technische Umsetzung, which is precisely the gap I have been hired to close on every engagement in the past five years. The fact that academyFIVE is already the leading product and still has a long architecture and platform roadmap ahead means the role is about compounding quality, not recovering from chaos. *That is exactly the environment where deliberate, technically grounded product ownership creates the most lasting value.*

§ AI-NATIVE STACK

Daily tools, not buzzwords.

- **Claude**, requirements drafting and edge-case generation
- **GPT**, stakeholder communication and doc synthesis
- **GitHub Copilot**, in-editor development support
- **Cursor / VSCode**, LLM-assisted spec and code review
- **Lovable**, rapid front-end prototyping
- **Framer**, design-heavy wireframing and stakeholder previews

- **Gamma.app**, structured product presentations
 - **n8n**, workflow automation and agent orchestration
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§ TECHNICAL ENVIRONMENT

Shipped with, not just listed.

Kotlin (Spring Boot), Python, Django, JavaScript, AngularJS, PostgreSQL, MongoDB, REST APIs, Kubernetes, ArgoCD, Helm, Argo Workflows, OpenShift, Docker, Jenkins, Bitbucket, Git, dbt, Dagster, DuckDB, MicroStrategy, Redpanda, Ionic, CGM API integration, Shopware, Java, HTML/CSS.

§ SIDE PROJECT

BACKTEST ENGINE & AGENT FRAMEWORK [GITHUB.COM/HILBERTP](https://github.com/HilbertP) →

Crypto-market backtesting engine and autonomous dev-agent framework built from scratch.

- Implements a file-queue-based multi-agent loop for autonomous code generation and iteration tasks.
 - Architecture uses Python with DuckDB for in-process columnar analytics on historical OHLCV and order-book data.
 - Active development with production-grade test coverage and GitOps-style rollout discipline.
 - Demonstrates the same end-to-end delivery ownership – spec, build, test, ship – expected of a technical PO who writes acceptance criteria and then validates them hands-on.
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§ HOW I WOULD WORK AT SIMOVATIVE

First weeks, concrete.

WEEK 1

Listen, map, find the gaps.

I would read every open Epic and the current architecture decision log, sit in on sprint ceremonies, and map where the gap between written acceptance criteria and what engineering actually builds is widest.

WEEK 2

Refine, prioritise, align.

I would run a focused refinement session on the highest-priority technical backlog items – architecture improvements, interface specs, performance work – and produce a first draft of rewritten stories that are unambiguous enough to estimate with confidence.

WEEK 3+

Ship, close, repeat.

I would take ownership of one complete feature thread from Epic definition through rollout, establishing the working rhythm between myself, development, architecture, and DevOps that the role is designed to create.

I COVER LETTER

Dear Simovative team,

Campus management software sits at the operational core of a university – enrollment, scheduling, accreditation, billing, document management, and integrations with third-party systems all converging in one product. That is not a simple domain, and it is not a role for a generalist who reads product books. It is a role for someone who can sit with an architect and a backend engineer in the morning and then explain the same trade-off clearly to a non-technical stakeholder in the afternoon. That has been my working mode for the past five years.

At Rohde & Schwarz, I owned the technical product roadmap for a central AI and data management platform inside the FCAS defence programme. The work required translating multinational, politically sensitive requirements into Epics, arbitrating architecture decisions with a distributed team of data scientists, backend engineers, and QA, and shipping features end-to-end – user stories, acceptance criteria, implementation pairing, testing, and GitOps rollout with ArgoCD. I reduced deployment times from several days to under forty minutes. I also unblocked an infrastructure problem in OpenShift that the project lead had been requesting from engineers for over a year; I delivered it in one week. That is the kind of initiative I bring to a technical PO role.

At Emil Group, I joined an InsurTech SaaS platform that had lost sprint discipline and was haemorrhaging senior developer trust. I split a bloated seventeen-person team into focused Scrum units, reintroduced velocity tracking and structured refinement, and delivered a Claims Center module from concept to production within that same engagement. More importantly, I rebuilt client confidence through transparent weekly product workshops – which is the same stakeholder communication muscle that a campus management product demands when working with university IT departments and administrative leads.

At the Federal Employment Agency, I served simultaneously as Product Manager and Deputy IT Security Officer on the Arbeitsmarktmonitor analytics platform, which means I understand the governance, compliance, and data lineage concerns that enterprise software buyers in public institutions care about. That experience directly maps to what academic institutions expect from a vendor's product team.

Simovative has been building academyFIVE since 2002 and is explicitly aiming to become the number-one campus management system in Europe. The roadmap signals in the job description – architecture improvements, interface standardisation, performance optimisation, platform evolution – are exactly the class of technical product work I find most rewarding. I would be glad to discuss how my background fits the team's current priorities.

Best regards, *Philipp Hilbert*

II CURRICULUM VITAE

§ BEARING

Hands-on Product Manager and Product Owner with nearly ten years of experience translating complex operational workflows into scalable B2B SaaS systems. Background spans enterprise data platforms, InsurTech, public-sector analytics, and defence-programme AI infrastructure. Comfortable owning technical backlogs end-to-end: from Epic definition and architecture review through sprint execution, stakeholder alignment, and GitOps rollout. Fluent in both the engineering conversation and the non-technical stakeholder conversation, and experienced in re-establishing delivery discipline in teams that have lost it.

§ CORE STRENGTHS

- Writing unambiguous Epics, stories, and acceptance criteria for complex software
- Bridging technical architecture and fachliche requirements across stakeholder groups
- Sprint restructuring, velocity recovery, and backlog prioritisation under delivery pressure
- End-to-end feature ownership from specification through production rollout
- REST API and interface design knowledge in B2B SaaS contexts
- Deputy IT security officer experience and compliance-aware product thinking
- ETL, data pipeline, and platform product ownership
- AI-native workflow integration into daily product execution

- Founder-level pragmatism: low ego, high agency, direct communication

§ PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

ROHDE & SCHWARZ 2024, 2025

Product Manager, AI Data Transformation

- Delivered autonomous feature sets end-to-end including user stories, acceptance criteria, implementation support, testing, and GitOps rollout via ArgoCD
- Reduced deployment times from several days to 20–40 minutes by introducing GitOps workflows
- Unblocked infrastructure-level issues in OpenShift independently; delivered in one week a feature the project lead had been requesting from engineers for over a year
- Led cross-functional team including architect, data scientists, backend and frontend engineers, and QA
- Improved data quality via filtering, tagging, reproducible transformation pipelines, and audit trails with full data provenance
- Responsible for SafeAI and ExplainableAI-compliant evaluation concepts with multinational stakeholders

FEDERAL EMPLOYMENT AGENCY (BUNDESAGENTUR FÜR ARBEIT) 2023, 2024

Product Manager, Public Data Analytics

- Owned the Arbeitsmarktmonitor analytics platform; delivered labour shortage analytics, flexible regional comparison tools, and modernised admin tooling
- Introduced Dagster for automated ETL and indicator generation; standardised CI/CD with full test integration
- Migrated legacy systems to Kubernetes and managed major system upgrades
- Served as Deputy IT Security Officer with focus on compliance, governance, and data lineage
- Designed interactive dashboards and community features aligned with regional stakeholder needs

EMIL GROUP 2022, 2022

Product Manager, InsurTech SaaS Platform

- Designed and delivered a Claims Center module from concept to production rollout on a B2B SaaS platform
- Re-established sprint discipline by splitting a bloated 17-person team into focused Scrum units and introducing ownership and deputy concepts

- Reintroduced velocity tracking and structured refinement practices lost under delivery pressure
- Regained client trust through structured communication and weekly product workshops
- Reduced senior developer attrition from near-total to a single departure

CLINET PLATFORMS 2021, 2022

Product Owner, Mobile Healthcare App

- Delivered core flows for digital anamnesis, meal and therapy plans, transport, chat, and patient document storage on iOS and Android
- Integrated CGM interface into hospital information system workflows
- Built stakeholder trust through transparent communication of technical complexity around legacy APIs and external databases
- Led a small team under tight deadlines with strict focus on highest-leverage features

§ FOUNDER & EARLY-STAGE EXPERIENCE

QCRYPT AG 2016, 2018

Product Owner, Quantum-Secure Encryption

- Owned product architecture for backup, restore/checkpoint, and data-encryption based on one-time-pad keys and true random number generator hardware
- Reduced setup time to under two minutes with no technical knowledge required from end users
- Served as deputy IT security officer; responsible for attack vector documentation and mitigation strategy

KVITT PAYMENT SOLUTIONS 2013, 2018

Founder & CFO

- Built a group-based P2P payment product from scratch: PSP integration, full UX/UI design, mobile app prototype
- Later acquired and operated by Sparkasse

AOK HEALTH INSURANCE, ITSCARE 2019, 2020

Proxy Product Owner

- Migrated internal webshop to Shopware including complex product catalogue and API integration
- Designed customisable approval policies across a multi-stakeholder procurement flow

§ LANGUAGES

German, native. English, C2.

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